

Music Technology

(A Level, Edexcel)

This course teaches you the theory and practice of Music Technology today. This will be approached through four areas of study. These are:

- Recording and production techniques for both corrective and creative purposes
- Principles of sound and audio technology
- Composition
- The development of recording and production technology

Through these areas of study you will learn how to:

- produce performances using sequencing software in a range of musical styles
- develop the skills required to make high quality digital recordings
- learn how to compose and arrange using music technology
- develop your knowledge of the principles and development of music technology
- learn how to control and interpret data

Entry Requirements:

A grade 4 at GCSE Music or a Merit in BTEC Music Practice. It is also possible to start this course without previously taking GCSE Music – please do come and talk to us about your musical skills and interests.

Course Content

A Level Exams	%	When?	What?
1: Recording	20%	Ongoing Submitted in Term 5 in Year 13	In this unit you will create a recording, chosen from a list of songs. You will learn the production tools and techniques needed to capture, edit, process and mix an audio recording.
2: Technology-based Composition	20%	Ongoing Submitted in Term 5 in Year 13	In this unit you will produce a composition to a brief set by Edexcel. You will learn about creating, editing, manipulating and structuring sounds to produce a technology-based composition.
3: Listening and Analysing	25%	Examined in Summer of Year 13 (1½ hour written exam)	This is a written examination that tests your knowledge and understanding of recording and production techniques and principles, in the context of a series of unfamiliar commercial recordings. There are three areas of study: Recording and production techniques for both corrective and creative purposes Principles of sound and audio technology The development of recording and production technology.
4: Producing and Analysing	35%	Summer of Year 13 (2¼ hour practical/ written exam)	This is a written and practical examination that tests your knowledge and understanding of editing, mixing and production techniques, to be applied to unfamiliar materials provided by Pearson in the examination. There are two areas of study: recording and production techniques for both corrective and creative purposes principles of sound and audio technology.

Career Links

This course would be excellent grounding for various Music Technology higher education courses. We have also seen a number of students find work as music producers using skills they have developed on this course.

For more information please contact Mr Clarke.